

\$160,000 in first-year compliance savings — still running 15 months later

How one multi-state direct-to-consumer wine shipper replaced roughly 80 hours a month of manual compliance labor **and** its incumbent shipping-compliance software with automation built by Compliance Vine's founder — and why the install still working, untouched, is the point.

~\$160K combined first-year savings (labor + software, one client)	~80 hrs/mo of manual compliance work before automation	45+ / ~490 jurisdictions / tracked license & filing line items	15+ months in production since April 2025, zero engineering intervention
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The problem

Serving as the client's interim CFO, Christopher Anderson watched mandatory compliance consume the back office: direct-shipper permits, sales/use and excise tax registrations, product and label registrations, and recurring reports across more than 45 US jurisdictions (plus Canadian provinces) — roughly 490 tracked license and filing line items on monthly, quarterly, semi-annual, and annual cadences, each with its own portal, account, due date, and renewal window. The work ran about 80 hours a month of skilled labor, on top of an incumbent shipping-compliance software subscription. Miss a filing and the penalty isn't a fee — it's the state license the business ships on.

What was built

Rather than add headcount, Anderson automated the workflow himself: a jurisdiction-complete tax and license tracker with a live dashboard (filings due in the next 30 days, due this week, and monthly / quarterly / annual rollups), per-month filing calendars, and an email-ready filing workbook that turns each period's obligations into ready-to-send submissions. The automation replaced both the manual process and the incumbent compliance software — the client's full obligation footprint in one system.

The result

Approximately **\$160,000 in combined first-year savings for this client — labor plus software together**: the ~80 hours a month of compliance labor it absorbed, the interim-CFO compliance work it eliminated, and the incumbent software subscription it replaced. The savings figure is scoped to this single engagement and to its first year; it is not an extrapolation.

The durability proof

The system was deployed in April 2025 and is still in production use more than 15 months later, with no engineering intervention since — the working files remain in daily service today. For compliance software, longevity without babysitting *is* the product claim: the workflow was automated well enough to be forgettable.

An honest limitation — and why it became Compliance Vine. This install is static: a point-in-time build that does not receive rule or rate updates, so its reference data ages as states change their rules. That gap is precisely what Compliance Vine productizes — the same automation, backed by a continuously verified rules engine (see the companion technical memo, “Distance to Five Nines”) and live pre-ship enforcement, delivered as maintained software rather than a one-off build.